

INTEGRITY RECORDS

UNDIVIDED

*A Call to Wholehearted Devotion
for the Artist Who Wants to Serve One Master*

*“Teach me your way, LORD, that I may rely on your faithfulness;
give me an undivided heart, that I may fear your name.”*

PSALM 86:11

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Scripture quotations taken from the Holy Bible unless otherwise noted.

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INTRODUCTION

The Prayer of a Whole Heart

Hezekiah was sick, and the prophet had just told him to put his house in order, because he was going to die. He didn't argue theology. He didn't bargain. He turned his face to the wall and reminded God of one thing — not his achievements, not his platform, not his reputation. He reminded God of the shape of his heart.

“Remember me, LORD, he said, how I have walked in your presence with integrity, with an undivided heart, and I have accomplished what is good.”

2 KINGS 20:3

That is the prayer this whole book is built around. Not a prayer for a bigger platform, a cleaner record deal, or a louder testimony — a prayer that when everything else is stripped away, what's left is a heart that was never split in two.

Integrity Records exists on the conviction that the word in its own name — integrity — isn't a marketing angle. It's a description of what an undivided heart looks like when it shows up in a career, a studio session, a Sunday morning, and a Tuesday afternoon nobody is watching. This book is about that heart: what divides it, what unites it, and what it costs to keep it whole in an industry built to split it in half.

Hezekiah didn't ask God to remember his best performance. He asked God to remember his whole heart.

CHAPTER ONE

The Divided Life

“A double minded man is unstable in all his ways.”

JAMES 1:8, KJV

A divided heart rarely announces itself. Nobody wakes up and decides to serve two masters openly. It happens the way most real divisions happen — one part of you pursuing God on Sunday, and a different part of you pursuing approval, comfort, or applause the other six days, each one convinced it's the real you.

For an artist, the divided life has a very specific shape. It's writing a lyric that's true in the morning and a lyric that's marketable at night, and slowly losing the ability to tell which one you actually believe. It's praying backstage and performing a version of yourself onstage that the person who prayed wouldn't recognize. It's not hypocrisy in the dramatic sense — it's fragmentation. A life lived as several smaller, incompatible lives, held together by scheduling rather than conviction.

What double-mindedness actually costs

James doesn't say the double-minded man is wicked. He says he's unstable — tossed by every wave, unsure what he actually wants, because he's never resolved who he's actually serving. That instability is the real cost of a divided heart: not a single dramatic fall, but a permanent inability to stand steady on anything, because part of you is always pulling toward a different center of gravity.

- A divided heart isn't usually two obvious masters — it's one sincere devotion and one quieter, unexamined one.
- Instability, not scandal, is usually the first visible sign of a heart that's split.
- The division is rarely resolved by trying harder. It's resolved by naming which parts are actually competing.

The good news buried in this diagnosis is that division can be named honestly without shame. Hezekiah's prayer wasn't the prayer of a man who had never struggled — it was the prayer of a man who could look back and see that, on the whole, his heart had not been split. That's available to anyone willing to look honestly at where the splits currently are.

REFLECTION

Where in your life or career do you feel like two different people, depending on who's watching?

What would it cost you right now to bring those two people into agreement?

CHAPTER TWO

Unite My Heart

“Teach me your way, LORD, that I may rely on your faithfulness; give me an undivided heart, that I may fear your name.”

PSALM 86:11

Notice what David doesn't pray. He doesn't pray, “help me unite my own heart.” He prays, “give me an undivided heart” — because he already knows the uniting isn't something willpower accomplishes. It's something asked for and received, the same way everything else in this relationship works.

This matters enormously for anyone who has tried to fix a divided heart through sheer discipline. Discipline can manage behavior for a season. It rarely unites a heart, because the split isn't usually a behavior problem first — it's a devotion problem. Two loves competing for the same throne don't resolve because you got better at hiding one of them.

Teach me your way first

The order in David's prayer is worth sitting with. He asks to be taught God's way before he asks for the undivided heart. Unity doesn't come from staring hard at your own fragmentation until it resolves. It comes from fixing your attention on one thing long enough that the competing attachments start to look smaller by comparison, not through suppression, but through proportion.

You don't unite a divided heart by fighting the second love harder. You unite it by looking at the first one longer.

For an artist, this reorders a familiar question. It's not primarily “how do I stop wanting the industry's approval?” It's “what would it look like to actually fear God's name the way David describes — to let that reverence become large enough that approval shrinks to its actual size?” The undivided heart isn't a heart with no other desires. It's a heart where one desire has become large enough to order all the others.

REFLECTION

What competing love has quietly been asking for the same devotion you've promised God?

What would it look like this week to ask to be taught, rather than to just try harder?

CHAPTER THREE

Undivided Devotion

“I am saying this for your own good, not to restrict you, but that you may live in a right way in undivided devotion to the Lord.”

1 CORINTHIANS 7:35

Paul writes this in the middle of a passage about marriage and singleness, and it's easy to miss how directly it applies far beyond that specific topic. His concern isn't really about marital status. It's about distraction — about anything, good or bad, that fractures a life into competing claims on attention and devotion.

An artistic career is one of the most effective distraction machines available, precisely because it doesn't feel like a distraction. It feels like the calling itself. Touring, content schedules, engagement metrics, brand partnerships — none of these are inherently wrong, but every one of them can quietly become the thing that actually organizes your attention, while devotion to God becomes the thing squeezed into whatever time is left over.

Undivided doesn't mean uninvolved

It's worth being precise here: Paul isn't asking anyone to abandon their work, their instrument, or their platform. “Undivided devotion” isn't a call to withdraw from the world of making music. It's a call to make sure that world stays subordinate to the devotion, instead of competing with it as an equal claim on your life.

- Ask what currently receives your best hours and your best energy — and whether that answer matches what you'd say out loud.
- A career can be fully pursued and still remain subordinate; the test is what happens when the two genuinely conflict.
- Undivided devotion is not measured by how little you do, but by what actually governs the doing.

The artist with an undivided heart isn't necessarily the one with the smallest career. It's the one for whom the career has never been allowed to become the true north — the one who could walk away from any part of it tomorrow without it costing them their actual identity, because that identity was never staked there to begin with.

REFLECTION

If your career and your devotion to God ever came into direct conflict, which one, honestly, would win right now?

What practical claim on your time currently outranks your devotion, even if you'd never say so out loud?

CHAPTER FOUR

Two Masters

“No one can serve two masters. Either you will hate the one and love the other, or you will be devoted to the one and despise the other. You cannot serve both God and money.”

MATTHEW 6:24

Jesus doesn't say serving two masters is difficult. He says it's impossible. Not inadvisable, not risky — impossible, in the same structural way that you cannot walk north and south in the same step. A master, by definition, claims the whole of you. Two of them claiming the whole of you at once isn't a division of labor. It's a contradiction.

This is the clearest possible language for what an undivided heart actually requires: not balance, not moderation, not a wiser allocation of percentages between God and everything else. A single, undivided loyalty, with everything else — including a career, an income, an audience — properly demoted to servant rather than master.

What 'money' stands for here

Jesus names money specifically, but the principle is broader than currency. Anything that can function as a master — anything you organize your decisions, your worth, and your fear around — qualifies. For an artist, that might be money exactly as named, or it might be recognition, relevance, or the fear of being forgotten. The test isn't the label on the thing. It's whether it has quietly taken the seat only one throne was ever built to hold.

You don't need two masters to divide a heart. You only need one master and one very convincing applicant for the job.

The undivided heart, then, isn't primarily a heart that avoids sin in the dramatic sense. It's a heart that has settled, decisively and in advance, who actually sits on the throne — so that every other legitimate good in life, however large it grows, stays correctly ranked beneath it.

REFLECTION

What is currently the most convincing applicant for the throne in your own life?

What would visibly change in your week if that applicant were demoted to servant instead of master?

CHAPTER FIVE

A Heart After His Own

Hezekiah's prayer echoes a description given generations earlier about David — a man described, despite his very public and very real failures, as someone after God's own heart. It's worth sitting with how strange that description is if “undivided” is read as a synonym for “flawless.” David was not flawless. He was, at points, catastrophically divided in his choices. And yet the description stands.

This matters because an honest reading of an undivided heart cannot mean a heart that never fails. It has to mean something closer to what Hezekiah actually claimed: a life that, taken as a whole, walked in God's presence with integrity — not a life without a single misstep, but a life whose overall direction and deepest loyalty were never seriously in question.

Undivided over a lifetime, not a moment

This reframes the goal in a way that should relieve rather than pressure. The undivided heart isn't a state you either maintain perfectly or lose entirely the first time you fail. It's closer to a compass than a scorecard — a heart that, even after a wrong turn, still knows which direction is actually home, and returns to it, rather than quietly relocating there permanently.

- A single failure doesn't retroactively make a heart divided; a settled, ongoing double loyalty does.
- Repentance is how an undivided heart handles a wrong turn — not proof the heart was never undivided at all.
- The measure worth asking is not 'have I ever failed,' but 'when I fail, which direction do I still recognize as home?'

Hezekiah could say what he said not because his life had been flawless, but because, at the deepest level of loyalty, it had been whole. That is the more honest and more achievable target this book is actually pointing toward.

REFLECTION

When you fail or drift, which direction do you still recognize as home — and how quickly do you turn back toward it?

What would it mean to measure your own heart the way Hezekiah measured his — by its overall direction, not its perfect record?

CHAPTER SIX

Practicing Wholeness

An undivided heart is not maintained by accident. Like anything received from God and then lived out in an ordinary week, it requires practices — not to earn it, but to keep recognizing it and returning to it when the week's pressures pull at the seams.

Daily practices worth building

- Begin the day naming, out loud or in writing, who currently sits on the throne — before the day's demands start competing for the answer.
- Keep at least one spiritual practice entirely private, untouched by audience, metrics, or platform.
- Regularly ask a trusted person outside the industry whether they see one version of you or several.
- When a decision arises that could go either direction, ask plainly which option treats the career as servant and which treats it as master.

The danger of managing division instead of resolving it

It's possible to become skilled at managing a divided heart rather than actually uniting it — keeping the two loyalties on separate enough schedules that they rarely visibly collide. This can look like maturity from the outside. It is actually just a more organized version of the same instability James described, postponed rather than resolved.

A well-managed division is still a division. It's just one that's learned to be quiet.

Wholeness isn't the absence of competing pulls — every artist will feel them. It's the practiced, repeated act of bringing those pulls back to the one place they're meant to be resolved, rather than letting them run on separate, unexamined tracks indefinitely.

REFLECTION

Where in your life have you gotten skilled at managing a division rather than actually resolving it?

What single daily practice would most help you notice the split before it grows quiet and permanent?

CHAPTER SEVEN

Undivided in Public

The deepest test of an undivided heart isn't what happens in private prayer — it's whether the person praying in private and the person performing in public are recognizably the same person. A heart can look whole in a quiet room and still split the moment a platform, a camera, or an audience enters the picture.

This is where integrity, in the plainest sense of the word, becomes visible to other people. Not integrity as a marketing value stated on a website, but integrity as wholeness — the same convictions, the same honesty, the same devotion, whether the room is empty or full.

What public wholeness actually looks like

- Saying the same things about your faith backstage that you say from the stage.
- Letting a bad night or a quiet season be visible, rather than performing a constant certainty you don't actually feel.
- Treating people the same whether they can advance your career or not.
- Being willing to disappoint an audience rather than perform a version of yourself you don't recognize.

None of this requires perfection in public. It requires consistency — the same heart, recognizably present, whether anyone is watching or not. That consistency is, in the end, simply Hezekiah's prayer lived out in front of other people: a heart that walked in God's presence with integrity, undivided, whether the room was empty or full of witnesses.

REFLECTION

Would the people who know you privately recognize the version of you that shows up publicly?

Where is the gap, if any, between who you are onstage or online and who you are in an empty room with God?

CLOSING WORD

A Life That Doesn't Split

Hezekiah's prayer worked, in the sense that matters most, not because it persuaded God of something God didn't already know, but because it was true. When he turned his face to the wall, he had nothing left to leverage but the actual shape of his heart — and it held.

That is the only real test of an undivided heart: not whether it can be defended in an interview or demonstrated on a stage, but whether it holds when there is nothing left to perform for, and no one left to impress. Integrity Records exists to help artists build toward that kind of heart — not a flawless one, but a whole one, one that could turn to the wall tomorrow and mean it.

Give me an undivided heart, that I may fear your name. That is still the whole of the prayer, and it is still freely available, however many times it needs to be prayed again.

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